



SOLUTION PROPOSAL

23 September 2026
For the ZISAR committee

THE SOLUTION

Student records, verification & elections portal

A single portal where every sponsored student has one file, every semester can be closed, notices reach the right people, and elections are fair — operated by ZISAR for members across Russia.

PREPARED FOR

Zimbabwe Students
Association in Russia

CONTEXT

Presidential & National
Scholarships

STATUS

Ready to build —
prototype live

1. Executive summary

ZISAR already runs a document upload portal. That solves filing. It does not yet give the association a reliable picture of each student, semester by semester.

This proposal replaces that filing cabinet with a **student records portal**. Every sponsored student has one profile. Each semester, the student submits results against that profile. A named verifier checks the sheet. Notices — including posters — go to the right city or cohort. Dates that can strand a student in Russia are tracked before they expire.

ZISAR remains the operator. The portal keeps the association's own verified record and can produce reports for the Presidential and National Scholarships Department. It does not, by itself, award, suspend, or pay a scholarship.

THE SOLUTION

One portal replaces the document pile and the chat-group work. Phase 1 is fully specified and already clickable. Production goes on the association's own server with a real database, sign-in, file storage, and email.

Build in three phases

PHASE 1 · FOUNDATION

Daily work, done properly

Profile, documents, semester verification, notices, admin queue, committee register, consent, emergency alert.

PHASE 2 · OVERSIGHT

Once the roll is real

Coordinators, appeals, semester report, elections ballot, help, travel, guides, mentors, events, graduation.

PHASE 3 · PARTNERS

Only with privacy rules

Scholarship liaison login, Telegram delivery, alumni closure, restricted welfare notes.

What this portal fixes

01

Semesters stay open

"Results uploaded" is not "this semester is verified for this student."

02

The file is incomplete

Phone, hostel, visa, and next of kin live in chat — until they don't.

03

Deadlines are manual

Someone has to remember whose registration ends this month.

04

Notices get lost

A poster in WhatsApp reaches whoever happens to be online.

05

Anecdotes to Harare

06

Committee in a chat

The scholarship office cannot see verified counts from one system.

No single page for who holds office — and no fair secret ballot.

This document sets the product. Scope below is fixed for phase 1; later phases follow once the roll is live.

2. Who it is for

Prospective students stay on zisar.ru. This portal is for members and the officers who verify them — plus temp accounts for applicants still in Zimbabwe.

PERSON	WHAT THEY COME TO DO	MUST NOT BE ABLE TO
Student	Keep their profile true, submit results, read notices, appeal, nominate and vote, ask for help, send an emergency alert	See another student's file, help request, or how anyone voted
Applicant NEW	Join cities, read honest briefs and city news, ask a city representative before travel	Open member files, documents, or ballots
Verifier	Open semester windows, check sheets, approve or send back with a reason	Delete history, decide their own appeal, run an election they stand in
Appeals officer	Review a contested verification; uphold or return to the queue	Be the same person who made the first decision
Welfare	Receive emergency alerts; answer help requests	Open the document vault unless also a verifier
City representative	Publish the good / bad / ugly brief, city news, answer applicant questions	Verify results or open passport images
Election officer	Run nominations and the secret ballot; publish totals	See how a named student voted, or stand as a candidate
Executive	Oversight by city and school, notices, committee cards, semester report, audit log	Edit a result a verifier has already signed

Core of the product (phase 1)

- **One profile** — identity, contacts, scholarship, studies, stay in Russia, emergency contacts, consent.
- **Document vault** — typed uploads with issue and expiry dates; versions kept when resubmitted.
- **Semester verification** — named window, student declaration + sheet, Verified / Query / Rejected with a reason.
- **Notices with posters** — audience by all, city, university, cohort, overdue, or expiring.
- **Elections overview + committee cards** — rules and who holds office now; ballot in phase 2.
- **Emergency alert** — reaches two named welfare officers from the profile phone and city.

LEAVE OUT

Stipends and bank details · membership card on the phone · housing or job board · automatic reading of Russian transcripts · replacing the Harare scholarship application.

3. How a semester closes

Verification is per session — autumn or spring — not “whenever a file arrives.” Preparatory faculty is recorded separately from degree years.

STUDENT

Declare & attach

Outcome, arrears if any, official sheet, and a tick that the sheet is theirs for this session.

VERIFIER

Check five things

Right person, right session, declaration matches sheet, file readable, profile complete enough.

OUTCOME

Written reason

Verified closes the semester. Query opens a reply. Rejected allows a fresh submission. No silent rejection.

Appeal (phase 2)

Within 14 days of a verified or rejected result, the student appeals to a named officer who did not make the original decision. Both decisions stay on the record. The officer does not type a new mark.

Semester report

An executive can produce a report for the scholarship office from verified sessions: name, programme, sessions cleared, arrears, missing documents. No passport images in the default export. The report does not suspend, restore, or pay a scholarship.

4. Trust & secrecy

Access

- Named roles; blocked pages name the rule.
- Every sensitive opening can be audited.
- Help requests visible only to welfare.
- Consent version and date stored at sign-up.

Elections

- Ballot never linked to the voter.
- Receipt proves the vote, not the choice.
- Officer and scrutineer are not candidates.
- City seats voted only by that city's members.

OPERATOR

ZISAR keeps the verified roll. The Presidential and National Scholarships Department receives a report. The portal does not decide scholarships.

5. What the committee can click today

A working prototype of this proposal is ready. Sample names and documents only. Sign in as any role from the demo switcher. Data stays in the browser until a shared database is connected.

LANDING

Brand-first entry

Public landing into sign-in. Association blog and city regions for members and applicants.

OVERSIGHT

Executive analytics

Break down members and semester progress by city, school, home province, cohort, and scholarship.

APPLICANTS

Before travel

Temp accounts join cities, read good / bad / ugly briefs, ask city representatives.

BALLOT

Secret elections

Nominations, voting, receipt, and totals — choices never appear in the audit log.

Screens already in the prototype

- ✓ Student profile (ten sections) and print view
- ✓ Document vault with versions and expiry
- ✓ Semester submit, query reply, appeal
- ✓ Verifier queue and review desk
- ✓ Notices with posters; events
- ✓ Secretary General blog
- ✓ Committee cards editor
- ✓ Election portal and officer console
- ✓ Welfare alerts, help threads, travel
- ✓ University guides and mentors
- ✓ City regions and applicant enquiries
- ✓ Semester report (print to A4)
- ✓ Audit log
- ✓ Role-based home screens

What is still out of the prototype

Real authentication, shared PostgreSQL, file storage, and email delivery belong to the phase 1 production build on the association's server. The schema for that database is already drafted beside the prototype.

DEMO PATH

Sign in as Student → submit a semester → switch to Verifier → clear the queue → switch to Executive → open Oversight → switch to Applicant → join a city and read the brief → switch to City representative → answer the enquiry.

6. How the portal is set up

These rules are locked into the design. They keep the product clear for members, officers, and partners.

VERIFICATION

ZISAR's own roll

ZISAR verifies submissions and can export a report for the scholarship department. The portal never suspends or pays a scholarship.

DOCUMENT TYPES

Green card stays

The upload type remains. The committee labels the physical paper once; the system already collects it.

FIRST SEMESTER

Named central verifiers

A small group of named verifiers runs phase 1. City coordinators join in phase 2 after one window has been completed.

SCHOLARSHIP OFFICE

Export first

No department login in phase 1. They receive a semester report without passport images. A liaison login is phase 3 only.

CURRENT PORTAL

Replace my-zisar.online

Phase 1 replaces the upload site once live. Running two systems would split the record again.

CALENDAR

Autumn and spring sessions

Windows follow the Russian university calendar. Preparatory faculty has its own window when dates differ.

ELECTIONS

One-year terms

Enrolled students with a complete profile vote. Quorum is set per election. A tie goes to a runoff. Leave holders may vote and may not stand.

ELECTION STAFF

Officer and scrutineer

Neither is a candidate. Academic verifiers do not inherit the election job.

WELFARE

Two named officers

Emergency alerts and help requests go to two welfare officers. The appeals officer is never the verifier on that file.

OUT OF SCOPE

Stay out

No stipends, no membership card app, no housing or job board, no automatic transcript reading, no Harare application replacement.

PRODUCTION HANDOFF

Before go-live, the executive enters the real committee names, appoints the two welfare officers, and names the first verifiers. The product does not wait on further design choices.

7. Delivery

The prototype proves the workflows. Phase 1 moves the same product onto the association's server with real accounts, a shared database, file storage, and email.

PHASE 1

Foundation release

Profile, documents, one semester workflow, notices with images, admin queue, elections overview with sitting committee, consent, emergency alert.

PHASE 2

After the roll exists

Ballot, help, travel, guides, mentors, events, appeals, semester report, graduation record, coordinators, full applicant city programme.

After one academic year on phase 1

The executive will be able to say, without opening a chat group:

- How many enrolled students have a profile
- For the last autumn and spring sessions: verified, queried, rejected, overdue
- Which universities have the most overdue submissions
- Which students have a visa, registration, or insurance date inside 60 days
- What was announced, to whom, and that a decision notice was sent
- Who holds each office, and when that term ends

HARD BOUNDARY

No stipend module, no public social feed, and no outside partner logins enter this plan.

CLOSING

One portal. One roll. Semesters that close.

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Full field lists and workflows: *ZISAR-Student-Portal-Proposal.md*